DESIGN RESEARCH · SEPTEMBER 2026

3:17

Luxury waitlist landing page research for a middle-of-the-night sleep brand

What premium beauty and supplement brands do on Refero, how to keep luxury and conversion in the same page, three design directions, and a section-by-section blueprint.



PREPARED FOR THE 3:17 FOUNDER

SOURCES: REFERO · 3:17 BRAND VISION · SLEEP SHOT RESEARCH

THE SHORT VERSION

Night hero, morning page: gold 3:17 in lamp light, then warm sand sections — with one solid button, email only.

01

It fixes the colour problem

Gold on sand is 2.06:1 contrast. That fails on screen. On near-black the same gold is 6.4–9.1:1.

02

The name becomes the hero

3:17 is a moment. The first screen *is* that moment: dark room, warm lamp, amber bottle on the nightstand.

03

Reading stays easy

The audience is 45+. Everything after the hero is dark ink on parchment (15.6:1) at 18px body size.

04

It's how luxury converts

Aesop, Prose, Function and Aplós keep the page quiet and make **one** solid button loud. No hype colours, no ghost buttons.

The page moves from night to morning as you scroll, which acts out the brand vision's before-and-after: *exhausted, frustrated, alone → rested, energised, hopeful.*

FROM THE BRAND VISION

What the brand asks for, and what it means on screen

BRAND VISION SAYS	SO THE PAGE MUST…
Helps women **fall back asleep** after waking 3–4 hours in	Name the exact moment, not "better sleep". The number 3:17 does the work.
Women who feel **dismissed**	Validate before selling. Being understood is the conversion event.
Founder lived it for **15 years**	Lead trust with a signed founder letter. It stands in for reviews before launch.
Value 1 · **Ingredient transparency**	Every ingredient, exact mg, one plain line on why. No proprietary blend.
Value 3 · **Truthful, no hype, no fear**	No fake timers or inflated counters. Honest urgency only (real batch size, real ship month).
Value 4 · **Approved by God**	Shape the tone (stewardship, care) and state it once, sincerely, in the letter or mission.
Roadmap · **Cool, Calm, Travel, Restore**	Preview "the 3:17 system" and let the list vote on what comes next.
Amber bottle, sand label, gold 3:17, black text	Build the web palette from the bottle, adjusted for screen contrast.

KEY FINDING

The bottle's gold-on-sand fails on screen. Gold needs a dark stage.



2.06 : 1 ✗

Gold #B89148 on sand #E6D7BE. Fails even the 3:1 large-text minimum. Works in print because foil catches light; screens can't.



2.60 : 1 ✗

Gold on parchment #F7F1E6. Still fails. Use a darker bronze (#7A5A22, ~5:1) if the wordmark must sit on light.



6.42 : 1 ✓

Gold on night #15110E. Passes for all text sizes.



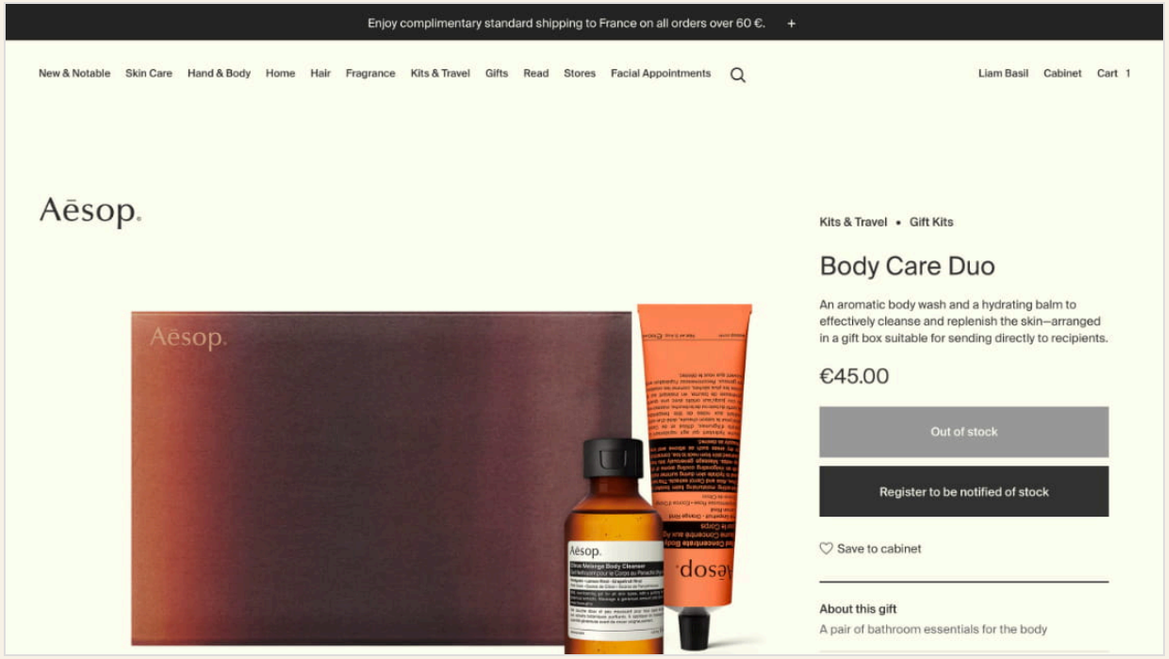
9.14 : 1 ✓

Light gold #D4B06A on night. Excellent, and glows like lamplight.

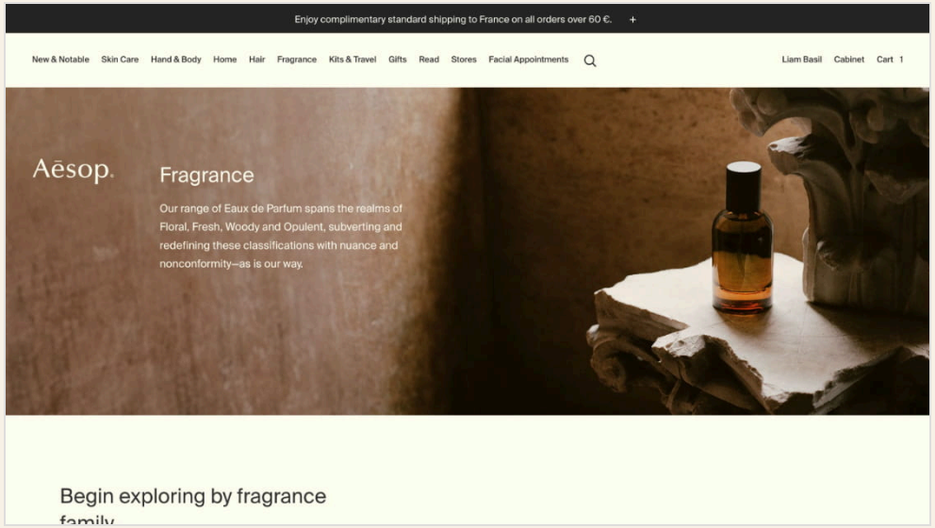
WCAG 2 contrast: 4.5:1 needed for body text, 3:1 for large text. Ratios calculated from the hex values shown.

REFERO EVIDENCE · AESOP

The luxury waitlist is one quiet, unmissable black button



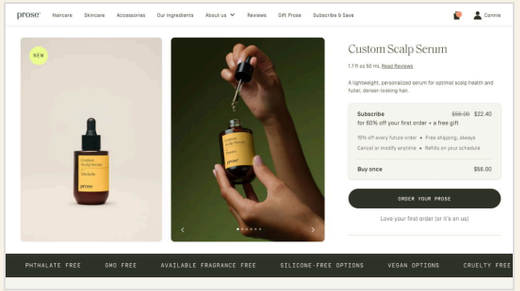
Body Care Duo, out of stock. Grey "Out of stock" bar with a full-width solid black **"Register to be notified of stock"** directly under it. Amber glass shot like a specimen on cream. Reassurance row below. Refero 7a61125e



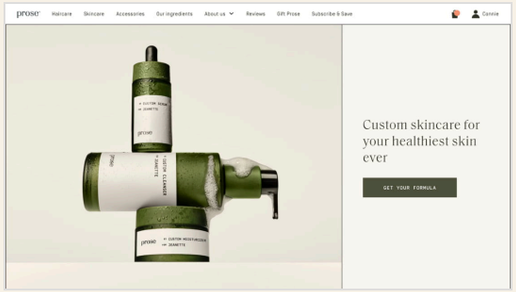
Fragrance catalog: the 3:17 hero photo. One amber bottle on warm stone, raking light, deep brown shadow. Swap stone for a nightstand and a lamp. Refero 9ffc9899

- Solid dark button, never a ghost button, for the one action
- Amber glass on warm neutral: the packaging world 3:17 is already in
- Reassurance row under the form (ships when · refund · privacy)

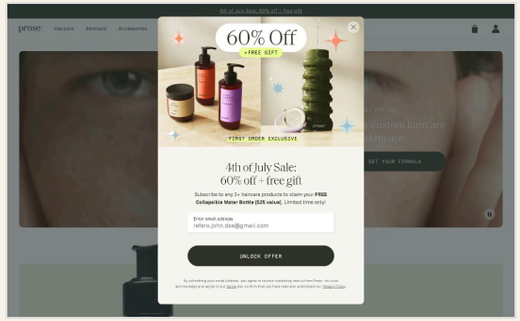
Amber dropper, cream label: the closest visual twin, with a full conversion system



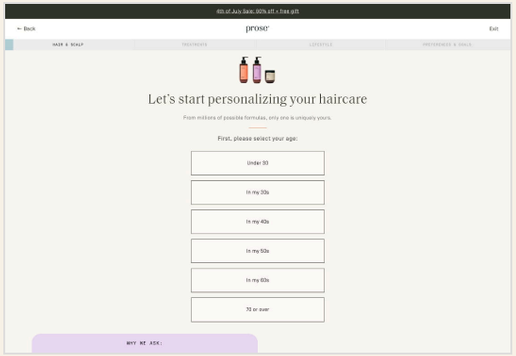
Buy box + attribute ticker. One dark pill CTA; "PHTHALATE FREE · GMO FREE…" band shows what's *not* inside.



Landing page. Two-column hero, one CTA repeated ~5×, stats grid ("proven effective in 4 weeks"), numbered steps, FAQ.



Email modal. One field, dark button, consent line. Skip the 60%-off framing: it cheapens luxury.



Quiz. Big outlined tap targets, progress bar, "Why we ask". Use it *after* signup: "What time do you usually wake?"

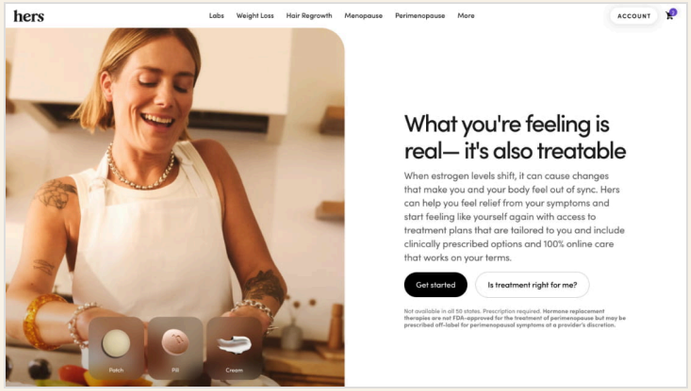
Take: ingredient cards (macro photo · name · exact mg · one line why) and a full ingredient index. That's Value 1 made visible.

Refero 539e88ba · 31719a5c · 8f2fd292 · 37684eed · 2d2e194e

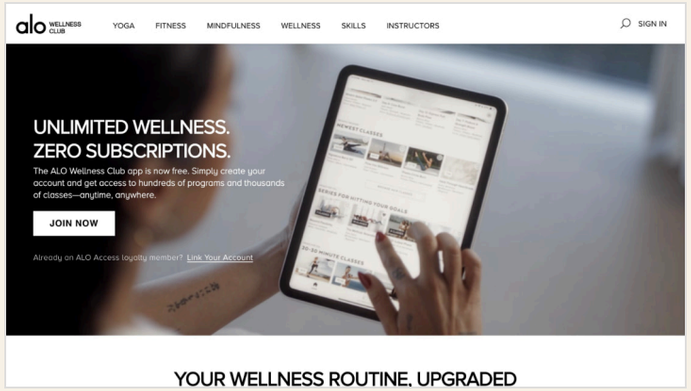
Take: the dark numbered "How to use" band becomes 3:17's bedside ritual: keep it by the bed → take it when you wake → drift back.

Take: the FDA disclaimer in a boxed footer note. Proof numbers only once real tester data exists.

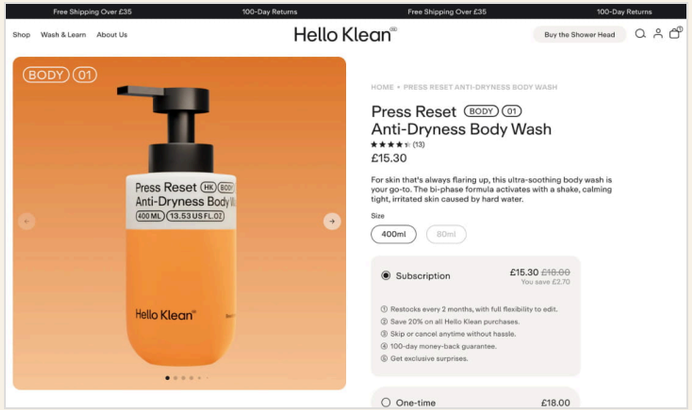
Validate first (Hers). Repeat the button after every doubt (Alo). Plan the launch offer (Klean).



Hers · perimenopause. "What you're feeling is real — it's also treatable." Validation before offer, a real midlife woman, a signed expert block, and a closing "Let's get back to you." **Borrow the message order, not the clinical look.** f0497969

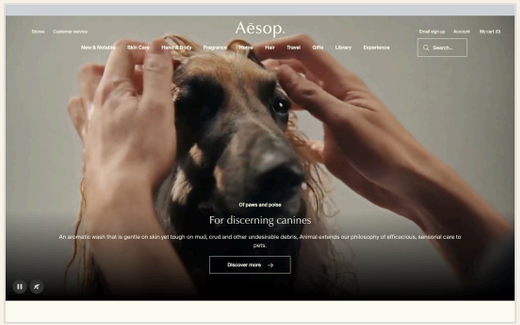


Alo Wellness Club. One "JOIN NOW" appears 4×, each after a section that answers a doubt. Stacked proof: review badge, quotes, "As seen in", expert faces. **Alo Gives** page is a model for the 1M-women mission. 09207b01 · a8c9cd31

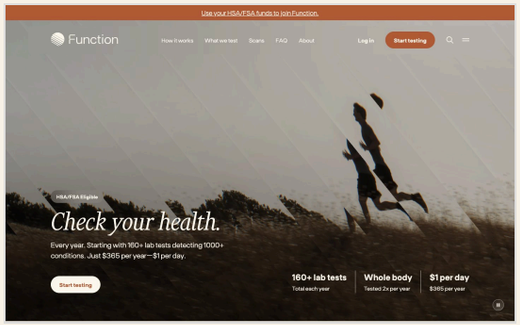


Hello Klean. Subscription vs one-time card with the saving, "cancel anytime", guarantee. Decide the **founding subscription price** now so the waitlist gets a clear launch-day offer. fdeaf0d4

Six visual languages to borrow from, and one warning



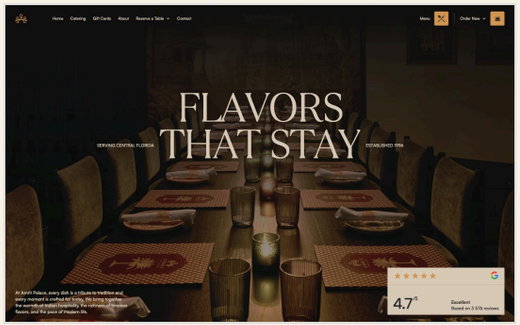
Aesop. Parchment, charcoal, umber; 0px corners; no shadows; 96–128px rhythm.



Function Health. One accent colour used *only* on CTAs. Warm credibility.



Aplós. Dark cinematic hero, then "Desert Sand" bands; gold on black. Avoid its ghost buttons.



Amrit Palace. Warm mahogany dark, parchment text, amber glow. The night palette.



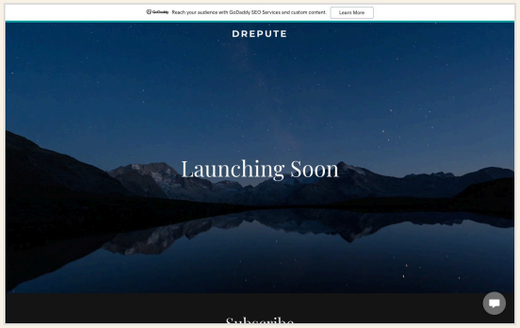
Alison Roman. Bookish cream, literary serif, one reddish-brown button. Founder-letter tone.



Emma Lewisham. One hero object, gallery calm. Label close-up idea.



Leandra Isler. Amber-beige canvas, botanical, wellness editorial.



Warning · Drepute. Beautiful night sky, "Launching Soon", nothing else. Atmosphere alone doesn't convert.

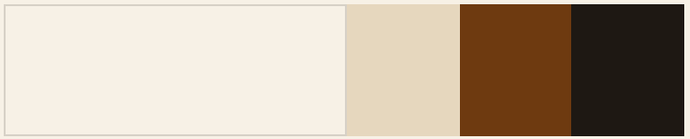
THE RULE

Quiet page, loud button

LUXURY HABIT	CONVERSION RISK	3:17 DOES THIS INSTEAD
Ghost / outline buttons	Missed; low contrast	**Solid** espresso or deep-amber button ≥ 8:1, identical everywhere
Thin serif everywhere	Hard for 45+ eyes	Serif only ≥ 32px; body in clear sans at **18px**
Gold text for elegance	2.06:1 on sand	Gold on dark only, or darker bronze on light
Mystery "launching soon"	No reason to sign up	What it is, who it's for, when it ships, in the first screen
No urgency	Low intent	**Honest** urgency: real batch size, real ship month. No fake timers.
Discount pop-ups	Cheapens the brand	Founding *privileges*: first batch, locked price, founder's note, a say in what's next
Full navigation	Every link is an exit (~10–15%)	Logo + one "Join" anchor. Nothing else.
Tiny caps labels	Illegible on phones	≥ 13px, never carrying key information

THREE DIRECTIONS

Apothecary, Night-to-Morning, or The Letter



A · LIGHT

The Apothecary

Aesop · Function · Prose

Parchment page, specimen-style amber bottle, charcoal type, one deep-amber button.

- Most legible and safest
- Fastest to build
- Gold logo must darken; looks like many brands



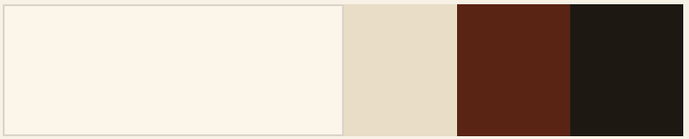
B · RECOMMENDED

3:17 a.m. — Night to Morning

Aplós structure · Amrit palette · Aesop lighting · Function button rule

Lamp-lit dark hero with the gold wordmark; the page moves into sand and parchment as you scroll.

- Ownable; the gold works
- Tells the before→after story with no words
- Keep dark areas short; photography is make-or-break



C · EDITORIAL

The Letter

Alison Roman · Savor · Hers message order

Opens like a letter: "For fifteen years, I woke at 3:17." Bookish serif, reddish-brown button.

- Most emotionally honest; strong for faith story
- Great for warm traffic (her network)
- Slower to show product; weaker on cold ads

Recommendation: build B and use C's founder letter as section 3. If launch traffic is mostly her own community, A/B test B against C.

Founding list open · First batch ships [Month] · [N] bottles only

3:17

Join the founding list

3:17 A.M.

For the hour you wake — and can't fall back asleep.

Natural middle-of-the-night sleep support for women in menopause. Keep it by your bed. When you wake, it helps you drift back to sleep.

Your email address | Join the founding list

One email when we launch, plus a note from our founder. No spam, ever.

Join 1,240 women who are done accepting 3 a.m. (real number only)



Real photo here: amber bottle on a nightstand, one warm lamp, linen, deep brown shadow (Aesop fragrance lighting). Gold-on-night button = 9.1:1. Logo-only header; the one link scrolls to the form.

PAGE BLUEPRINT

Twelve sections, one job each. The button follows every doubt it removes.

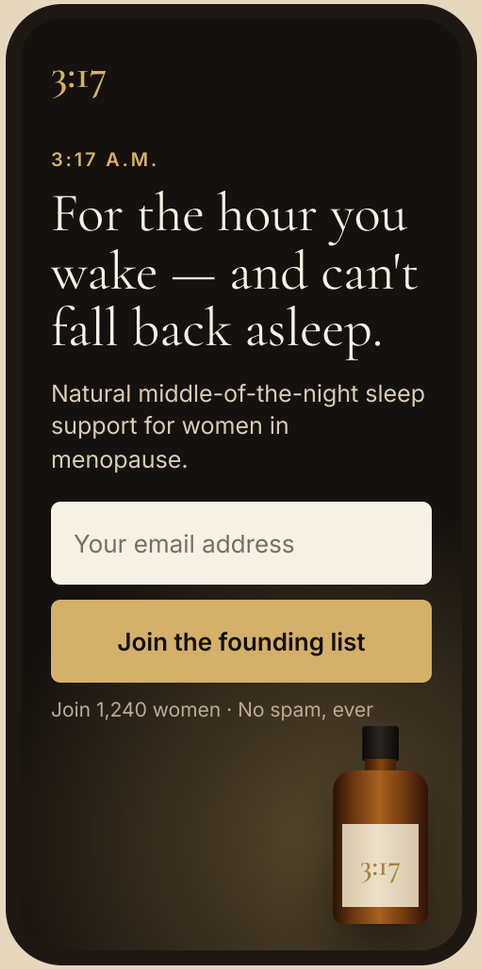
0	**Announcement bar** · honest urgency: founding list, ship month, batch size
1	**Hero · night** · headline, subhead, email + button, proof line, lamp-lit bottle, no nav • CTA
2	**Recognition** · "You're not imagining it." Her symptoms in her words Hers
3	**Founder letter** · 15 years, portrait, signature • CTA
4	**The ritual** · 3 numbered steps on dark amber Prose
5	**What's inside** · cards with exact mg + "what's not inside" ticker • CTA
6	**Proof** · testers (name, age, stage), advisor note; stats only if real
7	**Founding benefits** · first batch · locked price · founder's note · a say in what's next • CTA
8	**The 3:17 system** · Cool, Calm, Travel, Restore marked "in development"
9	**Mission** · one million rested women; giving; one quiet faith line
10	**FAQ** · grogginess, habit, HRT/meds, ship date, price, refund
11	**Final CTA · night** · "Tonight, when you wake at 3:17, be ready." • CTA
12	**Footer** · FDA disclaimer, privacy, contact

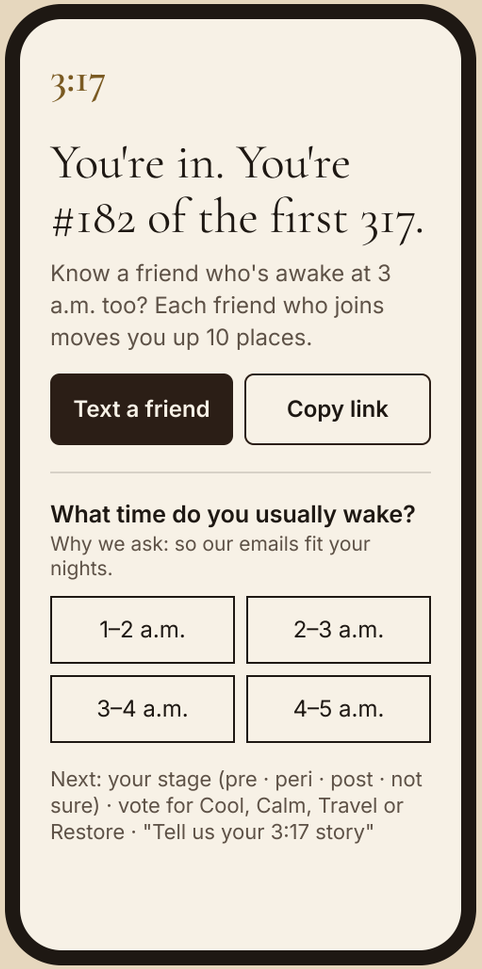


Scroll rhythm: night → morning → a dark-amber ritual band → sand benefits → night again for the last ask.

MOBILE FIRST · AFTER SIGNUP

Most launch traffic is a phone tap. The thank-you screen is where the list grows.





Mobile hero rules

- Headline, email, button and proof all visible before scrolling on a 390px screen
- Sticky bottom "Join" bar once the hero scrolls away
- Input font ≥ 16px (stops iPhone zoom), tap targets ≥ 48px, `type="email"`

Thank-you screen, in order

- **Real** queue position ("#182 of the first 317", if the founding batch really is 317)
- Referral by **text and WhatsApp** first; this audience shares in group chats
- Two-question quiz (Prose tap targets + "Why we ask")
- Vote on the next product, then an optional "Tell us your 3:17 story"

Welcome emails

Founder letter now → one ingredient story a week → "Why 3 a.m.?" education → 48-hour founding early access at launch.

DESIGN TOKENS FROM THE BOTTLE

Palette, type and shape, checked for contrast

Night	Espresso	Amber	Amber deep	Gold	Light gold	Sand	Parchment	Ink
#15110E	#2B1E16	#8C4A12	#6E3A10	#B89148	#D4B06A	#E6D7BE	#F7F1E6	#1E1813
hero, final band	button on light	bands, hover	alt button	on dark only	hero button	bands, cards	page	text

Back to sleep, not back to the ceiling.

Headlines · Cormorant Garamond 500 (free) → upgrade: Canela / Financier Display. ≥ 32px only.

Body · Inter or Figtree at 18px, 1.6 line height, about 65 characters a line. Clear for tired eyes at 3 a.m. and at 3 p.m.

Join the founding list

Reserve my place

PAIR	RATIO
Ink on parchment	15.63 ✓
Parchment on espresso (button)	14.37 ✓
Parchment on amber deep (button)	8.21 ✓
Night on light gold (hero button)	9.14 ✓
Gold on night	6.42 ✓
Muted ink on parchment	6.73 ✓
Gold on sand	2.06 ✗

Shape: solid buttons, 4–6px radius, ~56px tall, full-width on mobile · no shadows, hairline borders · 96–128px between sections (64–80 on mobile).

PHOTOGRAPHY · COPY · FAITH

Warm light, real women, true words

Four shots to commission

- **Hero:** amber bottle on a nightstand, one warm lamp, linen, deep brown shadow
- **Macro:** light through amber glass, a single drop, gold foil catching light (Savor textures)
- **Women 45–65:** rested, morning light, the *after*, never staged insomnia
- **Label close-up:** sand paper texture and the gold 3:17, proof of physical quality

Copy starters

- "For the hour you wake — and can't fall back asleep."
- "Wide awake at 3:17? So was I. For fifteen years."
- "You're not imagining it. And you're not alone."
- "Tonight, when you wake at 3:17, be ready."
- Buttons: "Join the founding list" · "Reserve my place"

Structure/function claims only ("helps you fall back asleep"), never "treats insomnia". FDA disclaimer on page.

Faith, with care

Let "Approved by God" shape the tone (service, stewardship, truth) and say it once, sincerely, in the founder letter or mission section.

For the founder to confirm: Zephaniah 3:17 reads in part *"he will rest in his love"* (KJV). If the name was chosen partly for this, it's a beautiful quiet layer for the letter or inside the label. The brand vision doesn't mention it, so ask first.

MEASURE AND TEST

Aim for 8–20% of visitors signing up. Test the biggest lever first.

Track from day one

- Visit → signup (the number that matters)
- Signup → quiz completed
- Signup → shared, and referrals per sharer
- By traffic source and by phone vs desktop

Benchmarks from the earlier report: cold traffic averages 2–5%; good pages reach 8–20%; warm community traffic 25%+.

Test order

- 1 · Headline: the moment vs the founder
- 2 · Night hero (B) vs light apothecary hero (A)
- 3 · "Join the founding list" vs "Reserve my place"
- 4 · Signup count shown vs hidden (once it's meaningful)
- 5 · Founding benefits above vs below ingredients

Never test fake scarcity or fake counters. It breaks "truthful in our words".

Before launch, have a lawyer check health claims, referral rules and email consent. Full notes: *research/317/3-17-waitlist-research.md* and the earlier Sleep Shot report §8.